

37

Chapter

Now Is the Time for Harvest

John 4:28-38; Matthew 9:35-38

Hymnal 400 (There's a Royal Banner)

Today's Lesson:



1. To understand that now is the time to harvest the souls.
2. To understand that we need to participate in the Bible seminars while earnestly praying.

Opening My Heart



In Aesop's fables, there is the story of the ant and the grasshopper that we're very familiar with. Do you like the ant? Or the grasshopper? What is the reason?



Understanding Today's Lesson

The purpose of a farmer cultivating crops is to gather an abundant amount of crops during the harvest. To achieve this, the farmer doesn't refuse to toil and work hard from the beginning of spring. And finally, when the harvest season arrives, the farmer reaps the crops with great joy and satisfaction. However, the window of time for harvesting grains or fruits is very short. If this time is missed, the grain quickly fades, and shortly thereafter, storms and snowstorms may strike. In that case, all the farmer's efforts and sacrifices become in vain. That's why, during the harvest season, people of all ages and genders join in to contribute to the harvest, putting in their effort to gather even a single extra grain.

The time we are living in is not the time for plowing the fields, sowing seeds, or tending to the crops; it is the time for harvesting, the season of reaping. In the Old Testament times, the Jews and prophets plowed the fields, and the Lord sowed the seed by giving His own life for the sins of the world as a grain of wheat. So, from the time of His resurrection becoming the firstfruits to His second coming is the time of harvest. We are the harvesters of souls living in the time to harvest the last souls of human history that God has determined to gather people to His kingdom. The time to harvest is running short, yet there are lazy workers who are just sleeping and foolish laborers who do not recognize that the harvest time is passing and are neglecting to reap the crops. What will happen to the crops that are just waiting to be harvested by such workers? Moreover, how would the heart of the owner, who has already paid wages to these workers and is waiting for them to harvest the crops, feel? We must be aware that the quantity of harvest and the fate of the crops that God gathers will be determined by us, who live in the final harvest time.

Notes:

Memorizing Scripture



And he who reaps receives wages, and gathers fruit for eternal life, that both he who sows and he who reaps may rejoice together.

(John 4:36)



Meditate

On These Verses

1. After you have meditated on the following verses, give a title of the verse(s) or write a short summary of the verse(s). Also, write down what you felt about the verse(s) or what other verse(s) it/they remind(s) you of.

(Proverbs 6:6-11)

(Ruth 2:3-7)

(Matthew 9:35-38)



Changing

Directions

Read John 4:28-38, and answer the following questions.

1. During His journey, Jesus became tired and weary. However, when His disciples brought food and offered it to Jesus, He postponed eating the food. What was the reason? What kind of lesson do you think this gives to us who are preparing for the Bible Seminar?
2. In verse 35, Jesus said “Behold, lift up your eyes and look at the fields, for they are already white for harvest!” However, it was not the harvest season at that time. What did Jesus mean by the harvest?
3. The Lord said that we are sent to reap what we have not worked for when we have already received our wages. What does this mean?
 - Already received our wages:
 - Gathers fruit for eternal life:
4. Jesus said there is one who sows and one who reaps. Which work is easier and more enjoyable, and which one is harder and more difficult? Why is that?



Applying

The Word to My Life

For as the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without works is dead also. (James 2:26)

1. Please write down how you will apply what you learned today throughout this week.

1)

2)

3)

2. Look back and reflect on how successful you were at applying last week's lesson.



Praying

To Live According to the Word

Let's pray that not only many souls will attend the Bible Seminar, but that all of them will be saved. And as a harvester who saves souls, let's seek to participate in the Bible Seminar.

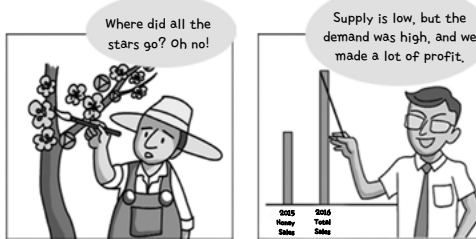


Our Story

The Earth That Grows Old Like a Garment



Because of global warming, it is getting harder to catch squid in the East Sea. The climate is gradually changing.



Because the honeybees are gradually disappearing, the farmers must pollinate the flowers with brushes to grow fruit.



You aren't able to notice these phenomena when you are living in the city, right? It's because we can buy all of these things from the market.

This is a very serious issue. However, we just continue to live our lives. We have no time in our lives to worry about these things.

Why is that? We only look at the road ahead of us.

And: "You, LORD, in the beginning laid the foundation of the earth, And the heavens are the work of Your hands. They will perish, but You remain; And they will all grow old like a garment; Like a cloak You will fold them up, And they will be changed. But You are the same, And Your years will not fail." (Hebrews 1:10-12)

Do It Tomorrow Morning

The steamship Central America, which was heading from New York to San Francisco, suffered an accident in the middle of the ocean when a hole developed in the ship's hull, causing water to enter. A passing rescue ship saw this situation and approached SS Central America.

"Is there something wrong?" asked the captain of the rescue ship.

"There's a hole in the ship causing water to come in, and we can't perform repairs at the moment. It's nighttime, and the passengers could also panic. The ship will probably stay afloat until tomorrow morning, so let's observe until then and make a decision," replied the captain of SS Central America.

With a sense of unease, the captain of the rescue ship spoke again. "Still, it might be better to transfer the people to our ship now, considering the danger."

However, the captain of SS Central America reiterated, "Let's wait until tomorrow morning."

Ultimately, an hour and a half later, SS Central America sank completely into the sea, leaving no trace. Due to a negligent approach to the rescue operation in a dire situation, they met their demise.

If you are given a chance of rescue right now, do not delay the time to accept the gospel.

